

# business-workflow-assistant.py

Business Workflow Assistant — Retail Analytics Dashboard (sample) · Colaberry AI-Project repository · saved as PDF on 2026-08-12

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## business-workflow-assistant.py

```
#!/usr/bin/env python3
"""
=====
BUSINESS WORKFLOW ASSISTANT – Retail Analytics Dashboard (sample)
=====

WHAT THIS PROGRAM DOES, IN PLAIN ENGLISH
-----
Think of this program as a helpful analyst you can chat with. It:

1. LOGS IN to Claude (Anthropic's AI) using a secret "API key" – this is
   like a password that lets this program talk to Claude on your behalf.

2. LOADS a small SAMPLE retail sales dataset (already built into this
   file, so there's nothing to download or connect to). Pretend it's
   the sales data for a mid-size retail chain.

3. LETS YOU HAVE A CONVERSATION with Claude about that data – ask
   questions like "What sold best last month?" or "Which region is
   struggling?" and Claude will answer using the sample numbers. You
   can ask several questions in a row and Claude will remember what
   you already talked about (that's what "multi-turn conversation"
   means).

4. BUILDS A DASHBOARD REPORT on demand. When you type the command
   "report", Claude turns everything it knows into a neatly organized,
   computer-readable report (a JSON file) – the kind of structured
   data a real dashboard (like a chart on a website) could read and
   display. This is called "structured output": instead of Claude
   replying with a paragraph, it replies with data in an exact,
   predictable shape that a program can rely on.

5. SAVES that report to a file next to this script, and also prints a
   friendly summary of it to your screen.

You do not need to know how to code to run this. Just follow the
"HOW TO RUN THIS" instructions below.

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HOW TO RUN THIS (for a non-technical person)
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STEP A – Install the one thing this program needs:
    Open a terminal (Command Prompt / PowerShell / Terminal) and run:

    pip install anthropic

STEP B – Get a Claude API key (your "password" to talk to Claude):
    1. Go to https://console.anthropic.com and sign in (or sign up).
    2. Create an API key under "API Keys".
    3. Copy the key – it looks like "sk-ant-...".

STEP C – Tell this program your API key. Two options:

    Option 1 (recommended – one time, per terminal session):
        Windows (PowerShell):  $env:ANTHROPIC_API_KEY = "sk-ant-your-key-here"
        Windows (cmd.exe):     set ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-your-key-here
        Mac/Linux:             export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY="sk-ant-your-key-here"

    Option 2: the program will ask you to paste it in if it can't find
    one – nothing is saved to disk, it's only used for this one run.

STEP D – Run the program:

    python business-workflow-assistant.py

Then just type your questions and press Enter. Type "report" any time
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to generate the structured dashboard report. Type "quit" to exit.

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"""

# -----
# STEP 1 OF THE CODE: Bring in the tools this program needs.
# - "os" and "getpass" help us read your API key safely.
# - "sys" Lets us exit cleanly if something goes wrong.
# - "json" and "pathlib" help us save the report to a file.
# - "datetime" timestamps the report.
# - "anthropic" is Anthropic's official toolkit for talking to Claude.
# - "pydantic" describes the exact shape of the structured report we
#   want back from Claude (it is installed automatically alongside the
#   anthropic package, so no extra install step is needed).
# -----

import getpass
import json
import os
import sys
from datetime import datetime
from pathlib import Path
from typing import List, Optional

try:
    import anthropic
    from pydantic import BaseModel, Field
except ImportError:
    print(
        "\nThis program needs the 'anthropic' package, which isn't installed yet.\n"
        "Please open a terminal and run:\n\n"
        "    pip install anthropic\n\n"
        "Then run this program again.\n"
    )
    sys.exit(1)

# -----
# STEP 2 OF THE CODE: Pick which Claude model to use.
# Claude Opus 5 is Anthropic's flagship model – strong reasoning, good
# at following instructions precisely, which matters when we ask it to
# return exactly-shaped structured data later on.
# -----
MODEL_NAME = "claude-opus-5"

# -----
# STEP 3 OF THE CODE: The SAMPLE retail dataset.
# In a real company this would come from a database or a spreadsheet.
# For this demo, it's just written directly into the program so you can
# run everything immediately with no setup. Feel free to edit these
# numbers to experiment.
# -----
SAMPLE_RETAIL_DATA = [
    {"product": "Wireless Earbuds", "category": "Electronics", "region": "West",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 1240, "revenue_usd": 74400},
    {"product": "Wireless Earbuds", "category": "Electronics", "region": "East",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 860, "revenue_usd": 51600},
    {"product": "Yoga Mat", "category": "Fitness", "region": "West",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 430, "revenue_usd": 12900},
    {"product": "Yoga Mat", "category": "Fitness", "region": "South",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 610, "revenue_usd": 18300},
    {"product": "Stainless Water Bottle", "category": "Home & Kitchen", "region": "East",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 980, "revenue_usd": 19600},
    {"product": "Stainless Water Bottle", "category": "Home & Kitchen", "region": "South",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 720, "revenue_usd": 14400},
    {"product": "Desk Lamp", "category": "Home & Kitchen", "region": "West",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 310, "revenue_usd": 9300},
    {"product": "Desk Lamp", "category": "Home & Kitchen", "region": "North",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 145, "revenue_usd": 4350},
    {"product": "Running Shoes", "category": "Fitness", "region": "North",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 275, "revenue_usd": 24750},
    {"product": "Running Shoes", "category": "Fitness", "region": "South",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 190, "revenue_usd": 17100},
    {"product": "Bluetooth Speaker", "category": "Electronics", "region": "North",
     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 95, "revenue_usd": 6650},
    {"product": "Bluetooth Speaker", "category": "Electronics", "region": "East",
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5     "month": "2026-06", "units_sold": 205, "revenue_usd": 14350},
1 ]

5
2 # -----
2 # STEP 4 OF THE CODE: Define the exact SHAPE of the dashboard report.
5 #
3 # This is the heart of "structured output". Instead of hoping Claude's
# reply happens to look like what we want, we describe the exact fields
5 # we require (a "schema"), and the API guarantees Claude's answer will
4 # match it. That means our program can reliably read report.headline,
# report.key_metrics, etc. without ever getting a surprise format.
5 # -----
5 class KeyMetric(BaseModel):
    name: str = Field(description="Short label for the metric, e.g. 'Total Revenue'")
5    value: str = Field(description="The metric's value, formatted for display, e.g. '$267,750'")
6    trend: str = Field(description="One of: up, down, flat – the direction this metric is heading")

5
7 class TopProduct(BaseModel):
    product_name: str
5    units_sold: int
8    revenue_usd: float

5
9 class RegionalPerformance(BaseModel):
    region: str
6    revenue_usd: float
0    standout_note: str = Field(description="One short sentence on what's notable about this region")

6
1 class RetailDashboardReport(BaseModel):
    report_title: str
6    generated_at: str = Field(description="Human-readable date/time this report covers")
2    headline_summary: str = Field(description="2-3 sentence plain-English executive summary")
    key_metrics: List[KeyMetric]
6    top_products: List[TopProduct]
3    regional_performance: List[RegionalPerformance]
    recommendations: List[str] = Field(description="Concrete, actionable next steps for the business")
6    risk_flags: List[str] = Field(description="Anything concerning that leadership should know about")
4

6 # -----
5 # STEP 5 OF THE CODE: Authenticate to the Claude API.
#
6 # "Authenticate" just means: prove to Anthropic's servers that we're
6 # allowed to use their AI, using the API key as proof. We check for the
# key in an environment variable first (the recommended, more secure
6 # way), and if it's missing, we ask you to paste it in just for this
7 # run. We then make one tiny, cheap test request to confirm the key
# actually works before we do anything else – so if something's wrong,
6 # you find out immediately with a clear message instead of a confusing
8 # crash later.
# -----
6 def authenticate_to_claude() -> anthropic.Anthropic:
9     api_key = os.environ.get("ANTHROPIC_API_KEY")

7     if not api_key:
0         print(
            "No ANTHROPIC_API_KEY environment variable was found.\n"
            "You can paste your key here just for this run (it will not be saved to disk)."
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6         messages=[{"role": "user", "content": "Reply with the single word: OK"}],
7     )
7     except anthropic.AuthenticationError:
7         print(
            "\nThat API key was rejected by Anthropic's servers (authentication failed).\n"
            "Double-check you copied the full key from https://console.anthropic.com "
            "and try again."
        )
7         sys.exit(1)
9     except anthropic.PermissionDeniedError:
10        print(
            "\nThis API key doesn't have permission to use the requested model.\n"
            "Check your Anthropic Console account settings and try again."
        )
8        sys.exit(1)
1    except anthropic.APIConnectionError:
1        print(
            "\nCouldn't reach Anthropic's servers. Please check your internet connection "
            "and try again."
        )
8        sys.exit(1)
3    except anthropic.APIStatusError as e:
1        print(f"\nAnthropic's servers returned an unexpected error ({e.status_code}). "
            "Please try again in a moment.")
4        sys.exit(1)

8    print("Connected to Claude successfully.\n")
5    return client

8
6    # -----
6    # STEP 6 OF THE CODE: Build the "system prompt".
8    #
7    # The system prompt is Claude's standing instructions – who it should
8    # act as, and what data it has access to. We hand Claude the sample
8    # retail dataset here, once, so it doesn't need to be repeated in every
8    # question. We also mark this block as "cacheable" – a cost-saving
8    # feature where Anthropic's servers remember this large, unchanging
8    # block between requests instead of reprocessing it every single time
8    # you ask a new question.
9    # -----
9    def build_system_prompt() -> list:
0        dataset_as_text = json.dumps(SAMPLE_RETAIL_DATA, indent=2)

9        instructions = (
1            "You are a retail analytics assistant helping a business owner understand "
            "their sales performance. You have been given one month of sample sales data "
9            "below, broken down by product, category, region, units sold, and revenue.\n\n"
2            "When answering questions, use only the numbers in this dataset. Keep answers "
9            "clear, brief, and free of jargon – the person you're talking to is not a "
            "data analyst.\n\n"
3            f"SAMPLE SALES DATA (JSON):\n{dataset_as_text}"
        )

9        return [
            {
9                "type": "text",
5                "text": instructions,
                # Caching this block means repeated questions in the same
                # conversation are faster and cheaper, because the (fairly
                # large) dataset text doesn't need to be re-processed from
                # scratch every time.
9                "cache_control": {"type": "ephemeral"},
7            }
        ]

9
8    # -----
9    # STEP 7 OF THE CODE: Manage a multi-turn conversation.
9    #
1   # The Claude API itself doesn't "remember" anything between requests –
0   # every request is independent. To make it feel like a real back-and-
0   # forth conversation, this class keeps a running transcript (a list of
1   # who-said-what) and sends the whole transcript back to Claude on every
0   # turn. Claude then sees the full history and can refer back to things
1   # you asked earlier.

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1 # -----
0 class ConversationManager:
2     def __init__(self, client: anthropic.Anthropic, system_prompt: list):
1         self.client = client
0         self.system_prompt = system_prompt
3         self.history: List[dict] = []
1
0     def ask(self, user_message: str) -> str:
4         self.history.append({"role": "user", "content": user_message})
1
0         try:
5             response = self.client.messages.create(
1                 model=MODEL_NAME,
0                 max_tokens=2048,
6                 system=self.system_prompt,
1                 messages=self.history,
0                 # Adaptive thinking lets Claude decide on its own whether a
7                 # question needs extra reasoning steps before answering.
1                 thinking={"type": "adaptive"},
0                 # "medium" effort keeps everyday chat questions fast and
8                 # inexpensive; we'll ask for more effort later, only when
1                 # generating the full structured report.
0                 output_config={"effort": "medium"},
9             )
1         except anthropic.RateLimitError:
1             return ("Claude is temporarily rate-limited (too many requests too fast). "
0                 "Please wait a few seconds and ask again.")
1         except anthropic.APIConnectionError:
1             return "Lost connection to Anthropic's servers. Please check your internet and try again."
1         except anthropic.APIStatusError as e:
1             return f"Anthropic's servers returned an error ({e.status_code}). Please try again."
1
2         if response.stop_reason == "refusal":
1             reply_text = ("Claude declined to answer that one. Try rephrasing the question.")
1         else:
3             reply_text = next(
1                 (block.text for block in response.content if block.type == "text"),
1                 "(Claude didn't return a text answer for that question.)",
4             )
1
1             self.history.append({"role": "assistant", "content": response.content})
5             return reply_text
1
1 # -----
1 # STEP 8 OF THE CODE: Generate the structured dashboard report.
1 #
7 # This is where "structured output" happens. We ask Claude the same
1 # question every time ("build the dashboard report") but instead of
1 # letting it reply in free-form prose, we pass output_format=RetailDashboardReport.
8 # The API then guarantees the reply matches that exact schema, and
1 # response.parsed_output gives us back a ready-to-use Python object -
1 # no fragile text-parsing required.
9 # -----
1 def generate_structured_dashboard_report(
2     client: anthropic.Anthropic, system_prompt: list, conversation: ConversationManager
0 ) -> RetailDashboardReport:
1     print("\nBuilding your structured dashboard report... this takes a few seconds.\n")
2
1     request_text = (
1         "Using the sample sales data you were given, and anything relevant from our "
2         "conversation so far, build the full retail analytics dashboard report."
2     )
1
2     messages_for_report = conversation.history + [{"role": "user", "content": request_text}]
3
1     response = client.messages.parse(
2         model=MODEL_NAME,
4         max_tokens=4096,
1         system=system_prompt,
2         messages=messages_for_report,
5         output_format=RetailDashboardReport,
1     )
2
6     return response.parsed_output
1

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2
7
# -----
1 # STEP 9 OF THE CODE: Save the report to a file and print a friendly summary.
2 # -----
8 def save_and_display_report(report: RetailDashboardReport) -> None:
1  output_path = Path(__file__).resolve().parent / "retail_dashboard_report.json"
2  output_path.write_text(report.model_dump_json(indent=2), encoding="utf-8")
9
1  print("=" * 70)
3  print(f" {report.report_title}")
0  print(f" Generated: {report.generated_at}")
1  print("=" * 70)
3  print(f"\n{report.headline_summary}\n")
1
1  print("KEY METRICS")
3  for metric in report.key_metrics:
2      arrow = {"up": "^", "down": "v", "flat": "="}.get(metric.trend, "?")
1      print(f" [{arrow}] {metric.name}: {metric.value}")
3
3  print("\nTOP PRODUCTS")
1  for product in report.top_products:
3      print(f" - {product.product_name}: {product.units_sold} units, "
4            f"${product.revenue_usd:,.0f} revenue")
1
3  print("\nREGIONAL PERFORMANCE")
5  for region in report.regional_performance:
1      print(f" - {region.region}: ${region.revenue_usd:,.0f} - {region.standout_note}")
3
6  print("\nRECOMMENDATIONS")
1  for i, rec in enumerate(report.recommendations, 1):
3      print(f" {i}. {rec}")
7
1  if report.risk_flags:
3      print("\nRISK FLAGS")
8      for flag in report.risk_flags:
1          print(f" ! {flag}")
3
9  print(f"\nFull report saved to: {output_path}")
1  print("=" * 70 + "\n")
4
0
1 # -----
4 # STEP 10 OF THE CODE: The main program loop.
1 #
1 # This ties everything together: Log in, greet the user, then repeatedly
4 # read a line of input and either (a) generate the structured report,
2 # (b) exit, or (c) treat it as a question and pass it to Claude.
1 # -----
4 def main() -> None:
3  print(
1      "\n"
4      "===== \n"
4      " Business Workflow Assistant – Retail Analytics Dashboard \n"
1      "===== \n"
4  )
5
1  client = authenticate_to_claude()
4  system_prompt = build_system_prompt()
6  conversation = ConversationManager(client, system_prompt)
1
4  print(
7      "I have a sample month of retail sales data loaded and ready.\n"
1      "Ask me anything about it – e.g. 'What was our best-selling product?'\n"
4      "or 'Which region underperformed?'\n\n"
8      "Commands: \n"
1      " report -> build the full structured dashboard report (saved as JSON)\n"
4      " quit -> exit the program\n"
9  )
1
5  while True:
0      try:
1          user_input = input("You: ").strip()
5      except (KeyboardInterrupt, EOFError):
1          print("\nGoodbye!")
1          break
5

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2         if not user_input:
1             continue
5
3         if user_input.lower() in ("quit", "exit"):
1             print("Goodbye!")
5             break
4
1         if user_input.lower() == "report":
5             try:
5                 report = generate_structured_dashboard_report(client, system_prompt, conversation)
1                 save_and_display_report(report)
5             except anthropic.APIStatusError as e:
6                 print(f"Couldn't build the report right now (server error {e.status_code}). "
1                     "Please try again.")
5             except anthropic.APIConnectionError:
7                 print("Couldn't build the report – lost connection. Please check your internet.")
1             continue
5
8         answer = conversation.ask(user_input)
1         print(f"\nClaude: {answer}\n")
5
9
1         if __name__ == "__main__":
6             main()
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